

DAY 26: SAVE ON SPECIAL EVENTS

Birthdays and Christmas happen on the same day every year. And since we know they're coming at least 364 days in advance, we're able to plan for them accordingly. But what about the bridal showers, baby showers, weddings, and graduations that pop up in between? Now that's an entirely different story.

Depending on how many you have to attend *and* give a gift for, I know firsthand how incredibly easy it is to blow through all the money you previously set aside for the next birthday and upcoming Christmas holiday. Sometimes it feels just as expensive to be a guest at these events as it is to put them on!

I distinctly remember the year almost everyone we knew was either getting married or having their first baby. Of course we wanted to be there to congratulate and celebrate with them, but by the third or fourth wedding, we were running low on funds. Not just for gifts, but also for all the bridesmaid gowns and tuxedo rentals too.

It made both of us take a step back, talk through, and consider how we would approach these kinds of events in the future. We didn't want to be stingy, and loved showing our support, but was there a way to do both for less?

You bet! These six tips keep your wallet intact *and* help you weather every wedding, shower, and graduation season with class. In fact, you might even find that these kinds of gifts are the most creative and fun to give of all.

1. SET A BUDGET

Any time I feel like my money is spiraling out of control, I know it's time to create a budget for that specific category. So in addition to our budgets for car insurance, groceries, utilities, etc., we now have a category for gifts too. This has saved us from "stealing" from other categories just to cover an upcoming wedding or shower gift!